

STRUCTURE OF THE THEORETICAL PAPER

INTRODUCTION

The introduction states the essence and purpose of the study, the general problem statement, and its connection with other scientific or practical tasks. The introduction describes the general context of the study and the main research questions. It provides a detailed description of the problem's current state of development, without resorting to an in-depth literature analysis. The purpose of the introduction is to provide the reader with complete information about the problem and possible ways to solve it; to briefly prove the relevance of the study, its scientific and practical significance, and relevance for consideration in decision-making and practice. **The length of the introduction should be 1–1.5 pages.**

LITERATURE REVIEW

This section analyses the research, publications, and regulatory framework (if applicable) that initiated the solution to the described problem. It highlights the previously unresolved issues that are part of the general problem under study. **This section should be at least 2 pages long.** Authors are advised to avoid excessive self-citation or excessive citation of a single researcher/journal. We recommend that the authors of the theoretical paper conduct a literature review using 50–60 analysed literature sources. In addition, it is necessary to keep track of:

- the geography of the analysed studies (studies limited to one region are perceived as less objective);
- the date of their publication (the authors must analyse both the fundamental theoretical works that laid the foundations for the study of the described problem, but also the most modern works that highlight current trends);
- quality of the scientific journals whose papers are used for the literature review (choose papers from authoritative journals, with high-standard review procedures and editorial ethics principles, as evidenced by the journals' indexing in reputable databases).

The review ends with a conclusion about the current state of research and formulates the purpose of the study, based on the results of the literature review and the information provided in the introduction.

METHODOLOGY, THEORETICAL AND CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

This section analyses the existing theoretical framework related to the theoretical problem under study, concludes on the current state of its research, and highlights the issues that have not been resolved yet. In this section, it is important to make it clear that the problem addressed in this paper is part of a general problem (this should be described in detail). It indicates the scientific theories within which this study is carried out, the continuation of which scientific provisions are the authors' developments and methodological limitations of the study. If the paper compares existing theoretical approaches, concepts, and models, it is important to clearly describe the system of criteria for this comparison. This section should not repeat the elements of the theoretical background described in the Introduction.

If the authors propose a new methodology, new theory, or new method, this section should describe it in detail. It should also be noted how the authors' suggestions contribute to the formation of a basis for further research and stimulate the further development of a particular field of knowledge. The main information is presented with detailed explanations, illustrations, and full justification. It also defines the hypotheses underlying the paper and provides theoretical arguments by which the author confirms or refutes the hypotheses.

This section also describes the stages of theoretical substantiation of the paper's main idea, which should be illustrated with tables or figures. The main formulas that the author uses to explain the logic of his or her thoughts should also be given here. If there are any restrictions on the information disclosure, this should be indicated in this section. The submitted text should be logically connected, clearly and concisely presented, and have an appropriate structure (if necessary, each part may have a title). The text should be written in a scientific style. **The length of this section should be at least 6-7 pages.** Tables or figures that are more than 1 page long should be included in the appendices.

DISCUSSION (this section is optional, but encouraged)

This section explains certain contradictions, if any, evaluates the suggested new theories and approaches for the development of the relevant scientific field, and compares the authors' methodological and theoretical suggestions with the results of related studies. For this purpose, up to 10 of the most relevant scientific papers are selected, in which other authors have attempted to solve a similar scientific problem, and a comparative analysis is carried out for each of these papers. It should be explained in detail how the methodology, methods and results of this study differ from the one being compared, what common and distinctive features these scientific works have, what new horizons this paper has opened up compared to previous studies, etc. In other words, in this section, the authors engage in a "virtual discussion" with their academic colleagues, the authors of previous works, explaining the

advantages and disadvantages of the approaches used. Each author's statement in favour of his or her own concept should be supported by facts or statements from other researchers.

CONCLUSIONS

This section is a summary of the research. The Conclusions section should begin with a commentary on what the research objective was and a detailed explanation of whether it was achieved. New phenomena, patterns, and confirmed facts should be briefly described and accompanied by appropriate comments. The Conclusions should be logically consistent with the title and purpose of the paper, thorough, and contain recommendations for further research. In this section, the authors should also indicate the study limitations (if any). In the Conclusions, it is advisable to provide a clear vision of the prospects for further research in the chosen research area. **The length of the conclusions should be 1–1.5 pages.** The conclusions should not refer to literature sources and repeat sentences from the abstract.